Desk review, Thu Oct 15

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Today looks like a washout, not yet a bottom: falling yields lifted the Dow and S&P 500 after an Asian chip crash. TSMC beat but TSM US trades 2–4% lower, so we run **branch M**: US orders by 3:30 PM, 2330 TT tonight, and today's low must hold Friday. On estimated fills the book is up $5.6k (+0.56%), with half still in cash.

The tape

Market	Move (US: open, then midday)	Why
Asia	Kospi −7.6%, Nikkei −4.9%, Taiex −3.4%	SK hynix −11%, Samsung −9%
S&P 500	−0.5%, then up to +0.3%; Dow up to +1%	Consumer, health care
Nasdaq	−1.3%, then −0.2% to −1.4%	SOX −4.2% on Wednesday
10-year yield	5.30% after PPI, then 5.05%	Bonds turned stocks

PPI: 6.3% y/y against 5.5% expected; Oct 28 hike odds 34–54%. Brent about $104, −2%.

TSMC and the branch

Revenue ($46.7B) and EPS ($4.60 per ADR) beat, and Q4 guidance implies +14% from Q3, but gross margin slipped to 66.4%. TSM US closed Wednesday at $430.00, then traded −3.8% at 10:26 AM and −2.4% at 11:49 AM. The 11:00 bar decides (−3% or worse is B); we take M either way, as the stock is back in the M band.

Positions and P&L

The book is up about $5.6k (+0.56%) with half still in cash; Lockheed carries most of the gain. These are estimates: each buy is assumed filled at that day's close, and marks are the latest quotes found. Replace them with the TMSG fills.

Name	Cost	Shares	Avg cost	Last	Value	P&L
VLO	$100.0k	218	$458.11	$459.78 (Oct 14)	$100.4k	+$0.4k (+0.4%)
XOM	$100.0k	570	$175.54	$177.01 (Oct 14)	$100.8k	+$0.8k (+0.8%)
RTX	$100.0k	541	$184.73	$186.47 (Oct 14)	$100.9k	+$0.9k (+0.9%)
LMT	$100.0k	195	$512.95	$530.60	$103.4k	+$3.4k (+3.4%)
GOOGL	$100.0k	288	$347.64	$347.64 (Oct 14)	$100.0k	$0.0k (0.0%)
Cash	$500.0k				$500.0k	
Portfolio	**$1,000.0k**				**$1,005.6k**	**+$5.6k (+0.56%)**

Buys: $50k of each energy and defense name Tuesday and again Wednesday, and $100k of GOOGL Wednesday. No Thursday price was found for VLO, XOM, RTX or GOOGL. Our score is the return relative to the WLS index, so check `WLS Index` on the terminal for the comparison.

Exit levels

Every level sits on the position's average cost after today's branch M orders, assuming they fill at the latest price. Nothing is within 5% of a level; the nearest is LMT, 5.6% below its first take profit.

Name	Size after today	Est. avg cost	Stop loss	Take profit 1 (sell ⅓)	Take profit 2 (sell ⅓ more)
VLO	$150k	$458.67	$421.97 (−8%)	$504.53 (+10%)	$541.23 (+18%)
XOM	$150k	$176.02	$165.46 (−6%)	$190.11 (+8%)	$200.67 (+14%)
RTX	$150k	$185.31	$174.19 (−6%)	$200.13 (+8%)	$211.25 (+14%)
LMT	$150k	$518.70	$487.58 (−6%)	$560.20 (+8%)	$591.32 (+14%)
GOOGL	$198k	$347.64	$326.78 (−6%)	$375.45 (+8%)	$392.83 (+13%)
NVDA	$100k	$216.30	$199.00 (−8%)	$237.93 (+10%)	$255.23 (+18%)
2330 TT (TSMC)	$100k	Tonight's fill	−7%	+8%	+15%

- **Stop loss:** a close at or below it means selling the whole position the next morning (US names by 10:30 AM).
- **Take profit 1:** sell a third and move the stop to cost. **Take profit 2:** sell another third and move the stop to take profit 1. The last third rides.
- **Earnings:** RTX reports Oct 20, VLO and LMT Oct 22. Decide by Monday whether to hold them through.
- Recompute every level from the actual fills tonight.

Today and Friday

- [ ] **By 3:30 PM:** NVDA $100k and GOOGL to $198k (both Friday if the Nasdaq-100 was down over 1.5% at 10:30); energy and defense to $150k each.
- [ ] **9:30 PM:** 2330 TT, $100k.
- [ ] **Friday:** a break of today's lows or a 10-year above 5.30% stops new AI buys; sweep cash into energy and defense. $990k+ invested by 3:30 PM.

Sources (noon ET search results; verify on the terminal): Yahoo · TheStreet · Yahoo live · Sharecast · Nasdaq (SOX) · TSMC 6-K · Investing.com · MSN (TSM) · Globe and Mail (PPI) · CNBC (PPI) · Trading Economics (Brent) · NVDA · GOOGL · VLO · XOM · LMT · VLO date · LMT date

Position prices: VLO Oct 13 · VLO Oct 14 · RTX Oct 13 · RTX Oct 14 · LMT Oct 13 and today · NVDA today. XOM's Oct 13 price is backed out of its Oct 14 move.